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Is Boston ready to stay up late all year?

Some officials, clubs say experiment with 3 a.m. closings should be permanent

By Alexa Gagosz
GLOBE STAFF

It was well after 1 a.m. and roughly 100 scantily clad clubgoers snaked down the block outside of Legacy, the LGBTQ+ nightclub in Boston's Theater District. With about 400 people downstairs, the club had long hit its capacity, but no

one seemed eager to give up their place in line.

Down Warrenton Street, more crowds spilled onto the sidewalks outside Icon and Venu. IDs were already pulled out. Vape clouds wafted overhead. Groups in stilettos and tight dresses passed around cigarettes before disappearing back onto

sweat-soaked dance floors, while others summoned Ubers to chase one more stop before closing time.

Normally, Boston nightlife would already be winding down. By 2 a.m., last call is over and the lights come up inside these beat-thumping establishments. But not this summer.

Massachusetts temporarily pushed closing times to as late as 3 a.m., if municipalities opted in, through the end of July for World Cup, America 250, and Sail Boston

celebrations, allowing nearly 200 bars and restaurants to stay open later. The experiment has boosted sales, filled seats and dance floors, and begun to chip away at Boston's reputation as a city that shuts down too early. Now, it's prompting a debate, with some city leaders proposing that the later last call should outlive the summer.

In late June, Boston City Councilor Brian Worrell filed a measure
NIGHTLIFE, Page A10

Scientists fear new funding threat

Proposed rule gives power to political appointees to make NIH grant decisions

By Allyson Chiu
GLOBE STAFF

For the past 10 years, Mark Albers has studied how existing medications could be repurposed to treat Alzheimer's, a disease that's expected to double in prevalence by 2060 and has no cure.

The work, which is funded by a grant from the National Institutes of Health, could yield a potential treatment faster than the often decades-long process of developing a new drug, said Albers, a neurologist at Mass General Brigham.

But the research — a joint effort by experts at MGB, Harvard Medical School, MIT, Imperial College London, and the University of Haifa in Israel — relies on access to large sets of data from other countries. And that global collaboration may be at risk as the Trump administration moves to overhaul how federal grants are awarded — including restricting international partnerships — to be in line with its “domestic-first” priorities.

With Massachusetts receiving the most NIH funding per capita, the proposed rules are expected to have an outsized effect on a state that is politically deeply at variance with President Trump's
RESEARCH, Page A7

LINDSEY GRAHAM 1955-2026

Trump ally, advocate for use of military

Was fierce supporter of Israel and Ukraine



Mr. Graham was a four-term senator.

Senator honored

Tributes poured in from across the world as word of the senator's death was announced. **A4.**

By Robert Jimison, Zachary Woolfe, and Amelia Nierenberg
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — Senator Lindsey Graham, a Republican from South Carolina and a onetime opponent turned stalwart ally of President Trump who was a forceful advocate for an interventionist US foreign policy, died Saturday evening. He was 71.

His office announced the death in a statement early Sunday. Mr. Graham had returned earlier Saturday from a trip to Ukraine and, according to Trump, had spoken to the president
GRAHAM, Page A4



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Priscilla Bessa (second from left) sat with her three children: Ricky, 7; Anna Luiza, 11, who has Rett syndrome; and Emanuele.

FINDING SUPPORT ONE CONTACT AT A TIME

She came from Brazil to get care for daughter, then she created a network

By Mariana Simões
GLOBE STAFF

A decade ago, Priscilla Bessa left a teaching career and a full life in Brazil to move to Massachusetts, where she knew almost no one.

Bessa immigrated so her 1-year-old daughter, Anna Luiza, could receive cutting-edge treatment at Boston Children's Hospital for Rett Syndrome, a rare brain disorder that gradually robs children of their motor skills.

Doctors helped Anna Luiza develop skills so she could go to school, but getting that care proved to be only the first challenge. As an immigrant, Bessa struggled to navigate the bureaucracy of Massachusetts schools, where access to special education can be a particular challenge.

Instead of accepting defeat, Bessa turned to her fellow immigrants whose children also had disabilities. She crowdsourced help in a five-member group chat on WhatsApp she nicknamed “Super Special Parents.”

A decade later, “Super Special Parents” has more than 500 participating families, making it the state's largest support network for Brazilians whose children have disabilities. The hyper-organized group chat requires prospective members to fill out a form and get approval to join.

“I became a trailblazer,” said Bessa, who lives in Northborough, “so that other Brazilian parents wouldn't have to work as hard as I did to figure it all out.”

Immigrants have long relied on informal networks to support newcomers from their

home countries, but community-run support systems have become increasingly important. National assistance has largely ceased as President Trump's crackdown on immigration has created a hostile environment for people from other countries.

At the same time, tight budgets have reduced resources for special education, making it harder for parents of children with disabilities to get services guaranteed under state and federal law.

Run by nine volunteers, the chat network provides crash courses on special education laws, events, and emotional support for parents fighting for the most vulnerable children.

New arrivals who don't speak English of
NETWORK, Page A7

Shore, shore

Monday: Sunny, breezy. High: 84-89. Low: 68-73.

Tuesday: Sunny, hot. High: 95-100. Low: 79-84.

Comics and Weather, **D4-5.** Obituaries, **C9.**

The United States launched several waves of strikes on Iran over an Iranian attack on a container ship in the Strait of Hormuz that set it ablaze and left a crew member missing earlier in the weekend. **A3.**

A massive fire tore through three buildings in Lawrence, leaving an estimated 60 residents displaced. **B1.**

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Bridge issue takes a toll on R.I. governor

Polls show McKee falling behind in Democratic primary

By Edward Fitzpatrick
GLOBE STAFF
and Dan McGowan
GLOBE COLUMNIST

PROVIDENCE — Rhode Island Governor Daniel J. McKee is in danger of becoming just the second sitting governor in state history to lose his party's primary, as weak poll numbers, sagging support within his Democratic base, and the political fallout from a high-profile bridge closure have left his campaign in a precarious position.

With less than 10 weeks until the Sept. 9 primary, multiple polls show McKee trailing by at least 20 percentage points behind Helena Buonanno Foulkes, the former CVS executive

who finished a close second to McKee in the 2022 Democratic primary.

“Look, a lot can happen in two months,” Providence College political science professor Adam S. Myers said. “But I think the dynamics have been pretty much the same for a long time now, and the trend over the past year has been Rhode Islanders moving away from Governor McKee and not toward him.”

Unlike many Democratic primaries across the country this year, Rhode Island's race is not an ideological showdown between a progressive insurgent and an establishment moderate. Both McKee and Foulkes occupy the party's pragmatic wing, with Foulkes drawing support from many of the same business leaders and establishment Democrats who once backed former governor Gina M. Raimondo.

Myers said McKee still has a base
MCKEE, Page A10

TALL SHIPS AHOY



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Members of the US Naval Sea Cadets lined up in front of a tall ship Sunday during the Sail250 event. While thousands of visitors toured the more than 50 tall ships and historic military vessels in Boston Harbor, many of the sailors had a chance to get off the ships and visit Boston. The tall ships depart Thursday morning. **B3.**